Adverse Event and Product Quality Complaint Reporting Procedure

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1. Purpose

Helix staff regularly hear from pharmacists, doctors and patients about problems with the medicines we distribute. This procedure makes sure that every such report reaches the Pharmacovigilance (PV) Officer quickly and with the information needed for evaluation. It applies to all employees, including sales representatives and drivers.

2. Definitions

- Adverse event (AE): any unwanted medical occurrence in a patient who used a product we distribute, whether or not it is thought to be caused by the product.
- Serious adverse event: an AE that results in death, is life-threatening, requires or prolongs hospitalisation, causes lasting disability, or causes a congenital anomaly.
- Product quality complaint: a report of a possible defect in the product itself, such as broken tablets, discoloured solution, a missing leaflet or a wrong label.

3. Reporting timelines

The clock starts when any Helix employee first becomes aware of the event.

- Serious adverse events: report to the PV Officer within 24 hours.
- Non-serious adverse events: report within 5 business days.
- Product quality complaints: report within 2 business days.

The PV Officer forwards every AE report to the marketing authorisation holder within 1 business day. The marketing authorisation holder is responsible for reporting to the national regulator.

4. Minimum information

A report is valid when it contains four elements: an identifiable patient (initials, age or sex), an identifiable reporter, the suspect product with its batch number, and a description of the event. Incomplete reports must still be sent on time; the PV Officer follows up for missing details.

5. How to report

Send the report by email to pv@helix-pharma.example using form HPD-F-017. Serious adverse events must also be reported by phone to the 24/7 PV hotline, extension 999.

6. Training

All employees complete pharmacovigilance training once a year. New employees complete it within 30 days of joining. Training records are kept by Human Resources.